

JavaScript Object this

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this in Objects

In JavaScript, the `this` keyword refers to an **object**.

Which object depends on how `this` is being invoked (used or called).

The `this` keyword refers to different objects depending on how it is used:

- In an object method, `this` refers to the **object**
- Alone, `this` refers to the **global object**
- In a function, `this` refers to the **global object**
- In a function (strict mode), `this` is `undefined`
- In an event, `this` refers to the **element** that received the event

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript Object this</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>this in Objects</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
// Create an object
const person = {
  firstName: "John",
  lastName: "Doe",
  age: 30
};

// Using 'this' would refer to the global object here
// But when used in a method, 'this' refers to the object

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "person.firstName: " + person.firstName + "<br>" +
  "person.lastName: " + person.lastName;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 1

Result [View Example](#)

this in an Object Method

When used in an object method, `this` refers to the object itself:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript Object this</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>this in an Object Method</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const person = {
  firstName: "John",
  lastName: "Doe",
  age: 30,
  fullName: function() {
    return this.firstName + " " + this.lastName;
  },
  birthYear: function() {
    const year = new Date().getFullYear();
    return year - this.age;
  }
};

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Full name: " + person.fullName() + "<br>" +
  "Born in: " + person.birthYear();
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 2

Result [View Example](#)

Why Use this?

The `this` keyword allows you to reuse methods across different objects without rewriting the code:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript Object this</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>Why Use this?</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
// A method that uses 'this' can work with any object
function introduce() {
  return "Hi, I'm " + this.firstName + " " + this.lastName;
}

const person1 = {
  firstName: "John",
  lastName: "Doe",
  introduce: introduce
};

const person2 = {
  firstName: "Jane",
  lastName: "Smith",
  introduce: introduce
};

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  person1.introduce() + "<br>" +
  person2.introduce();
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 3

Result [View Example](#)

this Alone

When used alone, `this` refers to the global object (window in a browser):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript Object this</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>this Alone</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
// In a browser, 'this' alone refers to the window object
let text = "this (global): " + this + "<br>";
text += "this === window: " + (this === window) + "<br>";
text += "this.document === document: " + (this.document === document);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML = text;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 4

Result [View Example](#)

this in a Function

In a regular function, `this` refers to the global object (window in a browser):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript Object this</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>this in a Function</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
function myFunction() {
    return this;
}

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
    "Function returns: " + myFunction() + "<br>" +
    "It's the window object: " + (myFunction() === window);
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 5

Result [View Example](#)

Document

Document in project

You can [Download PDF](#) file.

Reference

- [W3Schools JavaScript Object this](#)